

4.2 Linear Approximations & Differentials Worksheet

1. Find the linearization of the function $f(x) = \sqrt{x+3}$ at $x = 1$.
2. Find the linearization of the function $f(x) = \ln(2x-3)$ at $x = 2$.
3. Use a linearization to approximate the number $\sqrt{3.98}$.

4. Approximate the number $(1.06)^6$.

5. Use the techniques of linear approximation to estimate the following quantities. Write each answer in decimal form. *Show all work by hand.*

a) $\ln(0.9)$

b) $\sqrt{104}$

c) $\sin\left(\frac{\pi}{4} + 0.02\right)$

6. Consider the function $y = 2x^2 - \frac{1}{x}$.

a) Approximate Δy and dy as x changes from 1 to 2.

b) Sketch a picture of the curve and the values of Δy and dy .

7. Consider the function $y = x\sqrt{8x+1}$.

a) Find general formulas for Δy and dy .

b) Approximate Δy and dy when $x = 3$ and $\Delta x = 0.01$.